NATIONAL UNIVERSITY



Third Year Syllabus

Department of Anthropology

Four-Year B.S.S. (Honours) Course

Effective from the Session: 2013–2014

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

Syllabus for Four Year B.S.S. Honours Course
Subject: Anthropology
Session: 2013-2014

THIRD YEAR

Paper Code	Paper Title	Marks	Credits
234001	Anthropological Theory-II	100	4
234003	Political Anthropology	100	4
234005	Peasant Society	100	4
234007	Religion and Anthropology	100	4
234009	Environmental Anthropology	100	4
234011	Gender Issues	100	4
234013	Ethnic Identity and Nationalism	100	4
234015	Reading Ethnographic Texts	100	4
	Total=	**800**	**32**

Detailed Syllabus

Paper Code	234001	**Marks: 100**	**Credit: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Anthropological Theory-II**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

The Paper is designed to keep continuity in theory Paper taking queue from the previous Paper, hence it starts with the post Boasian trend ending of the return of Marxism in anthropological disPaper. The Paper is important since this will not only give a general overview of the theoretical trends but also how theories in anthropology progressed over the years.

1. Post Boasian Trends in Cultural Anthropology: Cultural Materialism: Marvin Harris Ray A. Rappaport Eric Wolf
2. Neo Evolutionist School: Julian Steward, Leslie White, Service and Marshal Sahlins.
3. Structuralisms from linguistic to anthropology: A Brief Background. Structuralism: Claude Levi-Strauss
4. The advent of Marx in anthropological thought: Structural Marxism: Meillasoux, M. Godelier and G. Dalton.

Required Texts:

Barnard, Alan, 2000, *History and Theory in Anthropology*, CUP, Cambridge, UK.
Eriksen, T. H. and F. S. Nelson, 2001, *A History of Anthropology*, Pluto Press, Sterling, USA.
Smith, Philip, 2001, *Cultural Theory: An Introduction*, Blackwell Publishers, Oxford, UK.
Layton, Robert, 1997, *An Introduction to Theory in Anthropology*, CUP, Cambridge.
Harris, Marvin, 1968, *The Rise of Anthropological Theories*.

Paper Code	234003	**Marks: 100**	**Credits: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Political Anthropology**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

This Paper is designed to get an understanding of the development of political system starting from the hunter gatherer society to modern nation state from cross-cultural perspectives. Different theories regarding the development of political systems and the states are discussed. The Paper will draw upon examples from different ethnographies and how these operated in different cultures and societies.

Paper Contents:

A. Political Anthropology: Development of political anthropology; definition, scope and different approaches
B. Evolution of political systems; Types of Pre-industrial state: band, tribe, chiefdom and state; the evolution of state, Anthropological theory of the state, Emergence of economic and political hierarchies, social stratification and power;
C. Emergence of factionalism ; Basis of Factionalism, Factions and local politics, anthropological approach to the study of Factions; Contribution of Peter Bertocci and Ralph Nicholas; horizontal and vertical alignment, Factions and local politics,

D. Political power and resource distribution; how do these affect development and inequality; Examples from Bangladesh and other countries
E. Power and Institutions in Bangladesh: Power Structures at Local and National Levels, Linkages between Local and National Power Structures, Factions and Local Politics

Required Texts and Articles:

Lewellen, Ted C. (1983) Political Anthropology. An Introduction. Bergin and Garvey Publishers.
Balandier, Gorges (1970) Political Anthropology. Allen Lane, The Penguin Press
Bertocci, Peter J. (1972) Rural Communities in Bangladesh: Hazipur and Tinpara. In Clarence Maloney, ed., South Asia: Seven Community Profiles, Holt Rinehart and Winston Publishers pp. 81-130.
Carneiro, Robert L. (1970) A Theory of the Origin of the State. Science, Vol. 169, pp. 733-38.
Nicholas, Ralph W. (1975) Factions. A Comparative Analysis. In Michael Banton, ed., Political Systems and the Distribution of Power, Tavistock Publications, pp. 21-61.
Alam, S. M. Nurul (1986) A New Look at the Dynamics of Social and Political Structure in Rural Bangladesh. Asian Profile, Vol. 4, No. 2, pp. 155-64.

Paper Code	234005	**Marks: 100**	**Credits: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Peasant Society**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

Anthropology has a long history and rich tradition in the study of peasant society. Therefore the aim of the Paper is to examine the socio-cultural, political, and economic characteristics of the peasantry from the historical and the anthropological perspectives. The Paper begins by examining the notion of peasant societies and the question as to why and how anthropologists began to turn their attention to the peasantry. The changing pattern of peasant society, their life and livelihood will be discussed. Examples will be drawn from ethnographic key texts both in and outside of Bangladesh.

Topics

A. Definition of peasants ; the place of peasantry in society; peasant, farmer and post peasant; peasant society as "part society and part culture"; Origin of agriculture; development of peasant society;
B. Anthropological study to the peasant society: Redfield, Wolf, Foster, Shanin and Chayanov;
C. Economic, social and political aspects of peasantry: Peasant social organization; peasant and markets; peasant economy and economic theories; state and peasants
D. Women in peasant society; changing roles and their contribution
E. Peasant Movements/ Resistance in South Asia'; Peasant 'movements (Tebhagha, Telengana and others)

Reading Lists

Wolf, E (1966) Peasants, Prentice-Hall
Redfield, R., (1960 hrs.). The little Community and peasant society and culture. The University of Chicago Press
Potter, Jack, M, May N.Diaz and George M. Foster . Eds.(1967). Peasant Society: A Reader. The Little, Brown and the Company. Boston
Shanin, T. Ed (1973) Peasants and Peasant Societies. Penguin
Halperin, R. and J. Dow, eds. (1977) Peasant Livelihood. St. Martin's Press
Kearney, Michael (1996) Reconceptualising the Peasantry. Westview Press.
Mencher, John P., ed. (1983) The Social Anthropology of Pesantry. Somaiya Publications

Paper Code	234007	Marks: 100	Credit: 4	Class Hours: 60 hrs.
Paper Title:	**Religion and Anthropology**	Exam Duration: 4 Hours		

Anthropological study of religion constitutes an important concern for anthropologists since the emergence of anthropology as discipline. Having considered this the Paper will survey some of the main conceptual issues in, and theoretical approaches to, the study of religion, and will examine the characteristics of religious ideas, practices and institutions and their relationships to other aspects of social life in specific contexts. It is necessary to examine religions in terms of their internal system of symbols and meanings as well as in terms of the relationships of religious practices and institutions to social processes.

Paper Contents:

A. Conceptualising religion; Typologies of religious beliefs, practices and institutions
B. 19th-Century studies on the origins and evolution of religion: Tylor, Frazer
The distinction between magic and religion
C. Religion and the maintenance of social order
Religion and solidarity: Durkheim, Turner
Religion as ideology: Marx
D. Religion and social change
Colonialism and 'revitalization' movements
The Protestant ethic and capitalism: Weber
Islam and agrarian change in Bengal: Eaton
E. Religion as a system of symbols and meanings: Geertz
Structuralist interpretation of myths: Lévi-Strauss
Psychoanalytical interpretation of myths: Freud
A. Religion in the contemporary world

Required Readings:

Morris, B. (1987) Anthropological Studies of Religion. An Introductory Text. Cambridge
Asad, T. (1993) The Construction of Religion as an Anthropological Category. In T. Asad,Geneologies of Religion. Discipline and Reasons of Power in Christianity and Islam, Baltimore: John Hopkins U. Press, pp.27-54.

Paper Code	234009	Marks: 100	Credits: 4	Class Hours: 60 hrs.
Paper Title:	**Environmental Anthropology**	Exam Duration: 4 Hours		

The relationship among the population, society, culture and human activities has become crucial in the backdrop of changes in the relationship and its impact on the economy, society, life and livelihood of people. Having recognized this the Paper focuses on the study of the relationship between society, culture and the environment, and also to the study of environmentalism as a cultural phenomenon. Different examples will be used to illustrate how human culture interacts with environmental phenomena and human intervention brings environmental degradation.

Paper Contents:

A. Environmental anthropology: Perspectives of human and environment relations; human's role in changing the environment
B. Different Approaches to the study of the environment-Anthropological methods in environmental research
C. Environmentalism: The basis of environmentalism
D. Adaptation –a core concept: Adaptation: genetic and non-genetic adaptation; Adaptation as resource management; Adaptation and mitigation strategies; Culture and adaptation
E. Ecofeminism**:** New disPaper(s) on nature, environment and women; Women, the environment and sustainable development; The impoverishment of the environment: Women and children last.
F. Environment and Development: Environmental impact of development ;Emergence of the disPaper of "sustainable development"; Who defines? Whose sustainability?
G. Agents of Environmental Degradation: Human's role in environmental degradation**;** Case Studies of Environmental Degradation: Green Revolution, Flood Action Plan, Deforestation
H. Environmental Movements: A review of different environmental movements; Case Studies: Chipko, Narmada, Green Peace

Required Readings:

Steward, Julian H., Evolution and Ecology, 1977, University of Illinois Press
Kormondy, Edward J., Concepts of Ecology, Prentice Hall, 1989
Ankelman, I. and J. Davidson, 1988. Women and the Environment in the Third World: Alliance for the Future. Earthscan Pubs, London.
Milton, Kay (ed.) Environmentalism : A View from Anthropology, Routledge, 1993
Sadeque, S. Zahir (ed), Environment and Natural Resource Management in Bangladesh, Bangladesh Sociology Association, 1992
Shiva, Vandana and Maria Mies, 1993, Ecofeminism, Zed Books, London

Paper Code	234011	**Marks: 100**	**Credits: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Gender Issues**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

This Paper has been designed to orient the students of the different theoretical perspectives and also the significance of this concept in understanding the social inequalities, particularly, universal subordination of women. It will explore the way differences are constructed between women and men and look at how these differences shadow unequal status of women and their exploitation. The Paper will incorporate the activities, struggles and power of women and also feminist theories and examine these questions through ethnographic writings.

A. The concept of Gender ; Epistemological foundation of the study of gender: The rise of feminist anthropology; Separation of 'Public' and 'private' spheres;
B. Biological determinism and sexual identity of women and men: Nature-culture (i.e private vs public), debate; Cultural construction of femininity and masculinity;
C. The concept of 'patriarchy': myths of male dominance; example
D. Types of feminist approaches: Liberal, Radical and Marxist; socialist; Third world feminism and Black feminism: Caution about ethnocentrism within feminism and anthropology.
E. Women in politics; women and the state; the state and oppression of women.

Women, the state and ideology;

F. Exploitation and Violence against women
G. Movements, resistance against male oppression;
H. Gender studies in Bangladesh; Laws to support women

Required Reading:

Tong, Rosemary (1995), Feminist thought: A comprehensive introduction, Routledge, London
Moore, Henrietta (1989), Feminism and Anthropology, Polity press,
Gould, Carol (ed) (1997), Gender: Key concepts in Critical theory, Humanities press: NJ
Mohanty, C.T., Russa, A. and Toress, L. (eds) (…..) Third World Women and the Politics of Feminism, Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
Ortner, S. (1974), 'Is Female to Male as Nature is to Cullure?" in Rosaldo, M. and Lamphere (ed) Woman, Culture and Society: A Theoretical Overview, Stanford University Press
Rosaldo, M. and Lamphere (ed) (1974), Woman, Culture and Society: A Theoretical Overview, Stanford University Press
Mac Cormack and Strathern (eds) (1995) Nature, culture and gender, Cambridge University Press
Stacey, J (1988) "Can there be a feminist ethnography?" in Bryman, Alan ed. Ethnography Vol. 3, Sage Publications: London.
Begum Rokeya, Oborodhbashini...

Paper Code	234013	**Marks: 100**	**Credits: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Ethnic Identity and Nationalism**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

It highlights the contributions of anthropology to the study of ethnicity and kindred phenomena. It also enable us to explore the ways in which ethnic relations are being defined and perceived by people; how they talk and think about their own group and its salient characteristics as well as those of other groups and how particular world views are being maintained contested and transformed.

Paper Contents:

A. Concepts:
Meaning and definition of ethnicity.Class, race and ethnicity.
Historical and theoretical perspective in ethnic issues in Anthropology.

B. Ethnic Classification:
Assimilation, the plural society, multiculturalism, the melting-pot metaphore; communicating cultural difference; Stereotyping; Ethnic stigma; Ethnicity from the individual's point of view; Criteria's for ethnicity

C. Theories of Ethnicity:
Different approaches to study ethnicity mainly provide by Smith, Geertz, Barth, Cohen etc.
Scools of ethnicity: Manchester school, Soviet ethnos school, constructionalist approach.
Ethnicity as a form of performance
Subjective and objective conditions of ethnicity
The cultural construction of ethnic and national identities

D. Emerging Issues of Identity: fluidity, narrative self: Identity as a process; The state and its margins; The question of frontiers: real, symbolic, and mental; the paradoxes of identity: where are the margins of the state; Migration, Diaspora, Hybridity and Post Nationalism.

E. Nationalism:
Nationalism Reconsidered: Nation as modern vs. ethno symbolism;
Nation as imagined community: Benedict Anderson
Invented Tradition: Eric Hobswam.

Nation and Nationalism: Ernest Gellner

F. Critical Theory on Race and Ethnicity: aye Harrison, Audrey Smedley,Brett Williams.

G. Issues Related with ethnicity and nationalism in contemporary World:
Prejudice and discrimination, indigenous people's movement, Religion and identity, Violence and identity, the modernity of religious fundamentalism, transnational movements and people's negotiation etc.

Required Readings:

Anderson, Benedict (1991) [1983]. Imagined Communities: Reflections on the Origin and Spread of Nationalism, 2 nd edition. London: Verso.
Banks, M. (1996). Ethnicity: Anthropological Construction. Routledge: New York.
Barth, F. (1996). Ethnic groups and boundaries: The social organization of cultural difference. Bergen/ London: UniversitetsForlaget/ George Allen and Unwin.
Erikson, Thomas Hylland. (1993). Ethnicity and Nationalism: Anthropological perspectives. London: Pluto Press.
Geertz, Clifford (1973)[1963]. 'The integrative revolution: Primordial sentiments and civil politics in the new states'. In Clifford Geerts.The Interpretation of Cultures, PP. 255-310. New York: Basic Books.
Smith, A.D. (1986). The Ethnic Origins of Nations, Oxford: Basil Blackwell.

Paper Code	234015	**Marks: 100**	**Credits: 4**	**Class Hours: 60 hrs.**
Paper Title:	**Reading Ethnographic Texts**	**Exam Duration: 4 Hours**		

The production of ethnographic texts continues to be an important part of the anthropological enterprise. However, ethnographies are no longer viewed merely as descriptive accounts of particular communities. The entire process from fieldwork to the writing of ethnographies and their publication has come under much scrutiny in recent decades. While both the poetics and politics of classic ethnographies continue to be examined critically, new experimental modes of ethnographic research & writing are also being developed . This Paper will examine some key issues surrounding the writing and reading of ethnographies on the basis of a few selected texts (both classics and contemporary ethnographies).

Selected Texts: (The Paper teacher will select 2-3 texts from the following list for intensive reading. This is just a list to guide but not an exhaustive list. However, if the Paper teacher thinks h/she can add new titles))

Balasco, Gay y and Huon Wardle., (2007). How to read ethnography. Routledge
Evans - Pritchard, E. E. (1940) The Nuer. Oxford University Press
Firth, Raymond (1936) We the Tikopia. London: Allen and Unwin
Leach, Edmund (1954) Political Systems of Highland Burma. Beacon Press
Malinowski, B. (1992, orig. 1922) Argonants of the Western Pacific. Routledge
Mead, Margaret (1928) Coming of Age in Samoa. Morrow Quill
Murphy, Yolanda and Robert E. Murphy (1985) Women of the Forest. 2nd Edition. New York: Columbia University Press.
Radcliffe-Brown, A. R. (1933) The Andaman Islanders. Cambridge University Press
Shostak, Majorie (1981) Nisa: The Life and Words of a !Kung Woman. Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press